

✦ FREE ROADMAP ✦ 2026 EDITION ✦

Financial Modeling & *Valuation* Mastery

THE COMPLETE FREE SELF-STUDY ROADMAP • 3-MONTH ACCELERATOR • AI-POWERED LEARNING

VOL. I, NO. 1 • MARCH 2026

✦ FOR ASPIRING ANALYSTS ✦

100% FREE • VIDEO-FIRST

@financewithshashvat

Financial modeling is the language of Wall Street, private equity, consulting, and corporate finance. In 90 days, following this roadmap, you will build three real models, speak that language fluently, and walk into interviews with work that hiring managers actually want to see.

Every resource listed here is free. Every project is built on real companies. Every AI tool listed has a free tier. The only thing this roadmap costs you is time — roughly 10–12 focused hours per week.

90

DAYS TO JOB-READY

5

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

\$0

TOTAL COST

10–12h

PER WEEK COMMITMENT

The Three-Month Phases

MONTH 1

Weeks 1-4

Foundations: Accounting, Excel & the 3-Statement Model

"You cannot model what you do not understand." Master the building blocks before you touch a DCF.

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

- Income Statement, Balance Sheet, Cash Flow Statement — how they link
- Excel shortcuts, formulas, and best practices for finance (INDEX/MATCH, OFFSET, IFERROR)
- Revenue & expense drivers, working capital mechanics
- Building a fully integrated 3-statement model from scratch
- Formatting, error-checking, and audit trails
- Reading 10-K/10-Q filings from SEC EDGAR

FREE RESOURCES

- **YouTube:** Corporate Finance Institute (CFI) — "3-Statement Financial Model" playlist
- **YouTube:** Kenji Explains — Excel for finance beginners
- **Course:** CFI's free "Financial Modeling Fundamentals" (corporatefinanceinstitute.com)
- **Course:** Coursera — "Introduction to Financial Accounting" by Wharton (audit free)
- **Practice:** Download a real 10-K from SEC.gov and manually trace all 3 statements

Valuation: DCF, Comps & the Full Analyst Toolkit

"Valuation is part science, part art, part narrative." Learn every method used by investment banks and equity research desks.

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

- Discounted Cash Flow (DCF): WACC, terminal value, sensitivity tables
- Comparable Company Analysis (Trading Comps): EV/EBITDA, P/E, EV/Revenue
- Precedent Transaction Analysis (Transaction Comps)
- Sum-of-the-parts valuation for conglomerates
- Football field chart — presenting valuation ranges
- Scenario and sensitivity analysis

FREE RESOURCES

- **YouTube:** Aswath Damodaran (NYU) — full "Valuation" lecture series (free, 30+ videos)
- **YouTube:** Wall Street Prep free YouTube tutorials on DCF
- **YouTube:** The WallStreet School — DCF & comps walkthroughs
- **Course:** Damodaran's free online course materials at pages.stern.nyu.edu/~adamodar
- **Practice:** Value a mid-cap company using all 3 methods; build football field chart

Advanced Models, AI Integration & Portfolio Building

"The analyst who knows AI tools will replace the analyst who doesn't." Build complex models and weaponize AI to work 5× faster.

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

- M&A / Accretion-Dilution model
- Leveraged Buyout (LBO) model basics
- AI-assisted modeling with Claude, ChatGPT, and Excel Copilot
- Python for finance: yfinance, pandas for financial data (free)
- Presenting findings: investment memo writing
- LinkedIn portfolio + GitHub setup for models

FREE RESOURCES

- **YouTube:** CFI — M&A Modeling and LBO basics
- **YouTube:** Kenji Explains — Python for Finance playlist
- **Course:** Coursera — "Mergers & Acquisitions" by NYU (audit free)
- **Tool:** Claude.ai (free tier) — paste SEC filings, ask for model assumptions
- **Tool:** Python + yfinance + Google Colab (free) for data automation

Essential Free Resources

► YOUTUBE CHANNEL

Aswath Damodaran (NYU Stern)

The "Dean of Valuation" uploads his complete university lecture series for free. 30+ hours of DCF, relative valuation, and investment philosophy. There is no better free resource on the planet for valuation theory.

VALUATION MASTER

► YOUTUBE CHANNEL

Corporate Finance Institute (CFI)

362K subscribers. Covers 3-statement models, DCF, comps, LBO, and Excel in structured playlists. Their free YouTube content mirrors their paid certification curriculum — use it as your primary structured course.

STRUCTURED CURRICULUM

► YOUTUBE CHANNEL

Kenji Explains

692K subscribers. Breaks down Excel for finance, forecasting, and capital budgeting into concise 15-minute lessons. Excellent for building practical Excel speed early in Month 1.

EXCEL SPEED

► YOUTUBE CHANNEL

The WallStreet School

119K subscribers. Step-by-step financial modeling for investment banking. Preferred training partner of EY, Deloitte, and McKinsey. Especially strong for Indian finance market context and valuation cases.

IB FOCUSED

● PLATFORM

Damodaran Online (NYU)

pages.stern.nyu.edu/~adamodar — Free datasets, valuation models, spreadsheets, and course notes going back decades. Download his valuation templates and reverse-engineer them as learning exercises.

FREE DATASETS

● PLATFORM

SEC EDGAR

sec.gov/edgar — Every public company's 10-K, 10-Q, and 8-K filings for free. This is your primary data source. Always build models from primary sources — not summaries. Learning to navigate EDGAR is a skill itself.

PRIMARY DATA

Essential Free Resources

★ FREE COURSE

Coursera Financial Modeling (Audit Free)

Multiple universities offer financial modeling and corporate finance courses. Audit for free — you get access to all videos and readings, just no certificate. Wharton's accounting and NYU's M&A courses are highly recommended.

UNIVERSITY LEVEL

★ FREE TOOL

Google Colab + Python

Free Jupyter notebooks in the cloud. Pair with the yfinance library to pull real stock data, automate financial statement downloads, and build data-driven valuation dashboards. No local setup needed — runs entirely in your browser.

PYTHON + AI

"The analyst who shows up with five real models built on real companies, with AI-powered commentary attached, will always beat the candidate who only has a certificate."

— THE PRINCIPLE THIS ROADMAP IS BUILT ON

5 Portfolio Projects That Get You Hired

01

3-Statement Integrated Model — A Real Indian/Global Company

Pick a listed company (Reliance, Infosys, Apple, or any public company). Pull 3 years of historical data from their annual report. Build a fully linked Income Statement, Balance Sheet, and Cash Flow Statement in Excel with color-coded inputs, formulas, and error checks. Forecast 3 years forward with clearly stated assumptions.

Excel Month 1 Accounting Core Skill

02

Full DCF Valuation with Sensitivity Analysis

Extend your 3-statement model into a full DCF. Calculate WACC (with sourced beta, risk-free rate, and equity risk premium), build a 5-year FCF forecast, calculate terminal value using both Gordon Growth and Exit Multiple methods, and build a sensitivity table varying WACC and growth rate. Present your implied price vs. market price.

DCF WACC Month 2 Valuation

03

Comparable Company Analysis (Trading Comps)

Select a sector (e.g., Indian IT, US SaaS, Consumer FMCG). Identify 8–10 comparable public companies. Pull key metrics (Revenue, EBITDA, Net Income, Debt, Market Cap) from SEC EDGAR or annual reports. Compute EV/EBITDA, EV/Revenue, and P/E multiples. Build a comps table and derive an implied valuation range for your target company. Include a football field chart.

Comps EV Multiples Month 2 Relative Valuation

04

M&A Accretion / Dilution Model

Model a hypothetical acquisition: one company acquires another. Calculate purchase price, deal structure (cash vs. stock), goodwill, transaction adjustments, and synergies. Determine whether the deal is accretive or dilutive to EPS in year 1 and year 3. This project alone puts you ahead of 90% of finance candidates.

M&A Accretion/Dilution Month 3 Advanced

05

AI-Augmented Equity Research Report

Pick a company. Use Claude or ChatGPT to help you rapidly parse the 10-K, identify key risks, and draft your investment thesis. Use Python (yfinance + Google Colab) to pull 5 years of stock and financial data automatically. Build a complete 1-page investment memo with: business overview, financial summary, valuation, key risks, and a Buy/Hold/Sell recommendation. Upload to GitHub and LinkedIn.

AI Tools Python Month 3 Portfolio Showcase GitHub

AI Tools to Use in Finance (Free Tiers Available)

Claude (Anthropic)

Paste entire 10-K sections and ask for assumption extraction, model logic, or WACC inputs. Ranked top for complex financial analysis. Extended context handles long filings better than other tools.

FREE TIER

ChatGPT

Use for writing VBA/Excel macros to automate repetitive model tasks, drafting investment memos, and quickly explaining financial concepts. Advanced Data Analysis feature can process uploaded Excel files.

FREEMIUM

Microsoft Copilot (Excel)

If you have Microsoft 365, Copilot is built directly into Excel. Ask in plain English: "Build a sensitivity table of NPV vs. discount rate from 8–14%." Generates charts, pivot tables, and formulas instantly.

M365 INCLUDED

Google Colab + Python

Free cloud Jupyter notebooks. Use the yfinance library to pull any public company's stock data and financial statements automatically. Pair with pandas and matplotlib to build professional charts for your portfolio.

FULLY FREE

NotebookLM (Google)

Upload entire annual reports as PDFs. NotebookLM indexes them and lets you ask specific questions: "What is the 3-year CAGR of gross margin?" or "List all capital expenditure guidance from management." Free and powerful.

FULLY FREE

Excel Formula Bot

Type what you want in plain English, get the exact Excel formula back. Free tier handles most needs. Ideal for Month 1 when you're building Excel muscle memory. Also generates Google Sheets equivalents.

FREEMIUM

90-Day End-of-Roadmap Checklist

MONTH 1 ✓

- ☐ Can explain how all 3 statements link
- ☐ Built a 3-statement model from scratch
- ☐ Know 20+ Excel shortcuts for finance
- ☐ Can navigate SEC EDGAR confidently
- ☐ Project 1 complete and saved on GitHub
- ☐ Started using AI to assist with filing research

MONTH 2 ✓

- ☐ Can build a DCF from scratch without a template
- ☐ Understand WACC and can calculate it manually
- ☐ Built a comps table for a real sector
- ☐ Created a football field valuation chart
- ☐ Projects 2 & 3 complete with investment memos
- ☐ Can explain valuation to a non-finance person

MONTH 3 ✓

- ☐ Built an M&A accretion/dilution model
- ☐ Understand basic LBO mechanics
- ☐ Use AI daily in finance workflow (prompts + outputs)
- ☐ Written Python code to pull financial data automatically
- ☐ All 5 projects on GitHub + LinkedIn portfolio
- ☐ Can walk an interviewer through any model live